

Alma Velazquez

Department of Political Science
Washington University in St. Louis

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🌐 <https://amvelazquez.github.io/>

Education

Washington University in St. Louis

Ph.D. Political Science, expected 2027

Dissertation: Land and Resource Nationalism in the Politics of Foreign Direct Investment

Committee: David Carter (chair), Timm Betz, Ted Enamorado, Amy Pond, Guillermo Rosas

University of Southern California

B.A. International Relations (Hons.), 2017

Minor Business Finance

Sciences Po Paris

Education Abroad Program, January-June 2015

Publications

Historical Border Changes and Contemporary Public Health Outcomes.
with David Carter and Matthew Gabel
International Studies Quarterly. Forthcoming.

Working Papers

The War of the Triple Alliance and the Gendered Reshaping of Paraguayan Society.
with Alex Avery
Revise & Resubmit at *Conflict Management and Peace Science*.

Sowing Discontent: Land, Sovereignty, and the Limits of Economic Openness. **(Job Market Paper)**
Under Review.

Seeing Like a Citizen: How Individuals Assess Territorial Threat.
with David Carter

Ground Rules: The Politics of Land Access.
with Hannah Loeffler and Amy Pond

The Spatiality of Public Goods: Borders and Support for Environmental Protection.
with David Carter, Masanori Kikuchi, and Tae Sung Oh

Beyond Greenwashing: International Certification and Local Legitimacy.

From the Fields to Foreign Markets: How Ethnic Minority Representation Transforms Trade Policy.

Works in Progress

The Politics of "Voice" in the International Investment Regime.

When the State Looks Away: Forbearance under Illegality in Brazil's Mining Frontier.
with Leticia Claro Oliveira

How Historical Border Instability Affects Patterns of Economic Innovation.
with David Carter

Grants & Awards

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| • Global Futures Small Grant (\$2,000) | 2025 |
| • Weidenbaum Center Small Grant with David Carter (\$14,000) | 2025 |
| • Department Research Grant (\$5,000) | 2024 |
| • Department Travel Grant (\$500) | 2024 |
| • Weidenbaum Center Small Grant with David Carter (\$15,000) | 2023 |

Conference Presentations

APSA (2025)
AMEI-ISA (2025)
MPSA (2024, 2025, 2026)
SPSA (2025)
IPES (2024)

Teaching

Instructor

Introduction to Python (G)

Summer 2024

Led graduate-level Python workshop, integrating lectures and labs on programming fundamentals and data analysis for Political Science.

Teaching Assistant

International Political Economy (UG)

Spring 2025

Amy Pond

Business and Politics (UG)

Fall 2024

Timm Betz	
Causal Inference (G)	Spring 2024
Christopher Lucas	
Quantitative Political Methodology II (G)	Fall 2023
Jacob Montgomery	
Introduction to Comparative Politics (UG)	Spring 2023
Guillermo Rosas	
Data Science for Politics (UG)	Fall 2022
Jacob Montgomery	

Academic Service

- **Organizer**, Comparative Politics Annual Conference (2026)
- **Discussant**, Comparative Politics Annual Conference (2026, 2025)

Skills & Additional Training

Languages: Spanish and English (Native), French (Fluent), Guarani and Portuguese (Novice)

Software Proficiency: R, Python, L^AT_EX, ArcGIS, SQL, Tableau

Workshop Participation: Geospatial Summer Workshop (2024), Text as Data Summer Workshop (2023)

Non-Academic Employment

Cerner Corporation, Kansas City, USA

Data Analyst, 2018 - 2021

Centro de Análisis y Difusión de la Economía Paraguaya (CADEP), Asunción, Paraguay

Research Intern, 2017 - 2018

Last Updated: August 13, 2026